## 7.2 DEFINITIONS

**Medical Aid:** refers to treatment by a doctor either on the sport at home or in hospital

**First Aid:** It is the immediate and temporary care given to an injured or sick person until the services of a qualified doctor are obtained with such material as may be available. The first aid is not an end by itself. It indicates that the person is in need of a secondary aid. First aid is based on the knowledge of biology, medicine and surgery. It can be a lifesaving skill.

**First aider:** The person who renders emergency service on the spot until the medical aid is obtained.

A sound knowledge based on first aid enables a nurse to give skilled services during accidents and sudden illness to preserve life promote recovery and prevent injury or illness being aggravated until the medical aid has been obtained.

## 7.3 RULES AND PRINCIPLES OF FIRST AID

### Golden Rules of First Aid

- Do first things first, quickly, quietly and without panic.
- Reassure the causality and his relatives sympathetically.
- Is there any failure of breathing? If yes start artificial respiration.
- Is there any failure of circulation? If yes start external cardiac massage.
- Is there seIf the cause of the accident is still there, remove it or the casualty from danger.
- Be calm, Methodical and quick but gentle in handling the casualty. (4)
- As far as possible keep the casualty where he is until everything is ready for transporting him.
- Look for the following and treat this first (a) Failure of Breathing. (b) Bleeding. (c) Unconsciousness
- Reassurethe casualty and others present to reduce shock.
- See that the casualty is in best position to aid recovery.
- Clear the croud tactfully. The casualty needs fresh air. Any other first aider present mayhelp you. Get help also to call the police, direct traffic etc as needed.
- Diagnose injuries and give firstaid that is essential. Make use of available first aid equipment's. If there is none, improvise the material at hand.
- Arrange for medical aid as soon as possible, for careful transport, and for informing relatives.
- Stay with the casualty, continuing to observe and give care until handing over to the doctor.
- Do not attempt too much: do the minimum first aid so that the conditions does not become worse and life can be saved.
- Do not remove clothing unnecessarily, as this may add to shock.
- Do not give anything by mouth to a casualty who is unconscious, who may have an internal injury or who may soon be given an anaesthesia.

## 7.4 FIRE

Rapid clear thinking at the fire is vital. Fire spreads very quickly, so warn any people



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